GOVERNMENT OF INDIA

# Ministry of Ports, Shipping & Waterways

## Connecting India to Global Horizons

Confidential and Proprietory

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# SHRI NARENDRA MODI

## HONORABLE PRIME MINISTER, INDIA



## MESSAGE



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# SHRI SARBANANDA SONOWAL



**HONORABLE MINISTER,**

**MINISTRY OF PORTS, SHIPPING AND WATERWAYS**

## MESSAGE



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# SHRI MUNINDRA KUMAR

## DIRECTOR GENERAL, CHAMBER OF COMMERCE AND INDUSTRIES OF INDIA



# MESSAGE

India's maritime sector is a vital engine of economic growth, international trade, logistics efficiency, and regional connectivity. The Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways plays a transformative role in strengthening port infrastructure, enhancing maritime logistics, promoting inland waterways, encouraging shipbuilding, and improving the overall competitiveness of India's transportation ecosystem.

The Chamber of Commerce and Industries of India (CCI India) recognizes the immense opportunities presented by India's maritime economy in driving industrial development, exports, investment, employment, and global trade integration. Through policy advocacy, infrastructure partnerships, investment promotion, technology adoption, industry collaboration, and innovation-led initiatives, CCI India remains committed to supporting the Ministry's vision of creating world-class maritime infrastructure and logistics systems.

This Knowledge Paper provides comprehensive insights into the Ministry's strategic priorities, maritime policies, infrastructure development programmes, investment landscape, and emerging opportunities across ports, shipping, inland waterways, logistics, coastal development, shipbuilding, smart port technologies, and green maritime initiatives. It also identifies collaborative areas that can strengthen India's position as a leading maritime nation.

The publication serves as a valuable resource for policymakers, port authorities, logistics providers, shipping companies, investors, infrastructure developers, technology firms, academic institutions, and development organizations interested in advancing India's maritime sector. Through collaborative partnerships and knowledge exchange, it seeks to promote innovation, improve logistics efficiency, enhance trade competitiveness, and support sustainable economic growth.

As India continues to expand its maritime capabilities under its long-term development vision, integrated planning and strategic collaboration will remain key to unlocking the full potential of the blue economy. CCI India remains committed to partnering with the Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways in building a modern, sustainable, and globally competitive maritime ecosystem.

Munindra Kumar
Director General
CCI India



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# Preface

India's maritime sector is central to the nation's economic growth, with nearly 95% of trade by volume and around 70% by value moving through its ports. As the custodian of over 11,000 kilometres of coastline, 12 Major Port Authorities, national waterways, and an expanding shipbuilding ecosystem, the Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways plays a pivotal role in strengthening India's global trade competitiveness and advancing the vision of a Viksit Bharat by 2047.

Over the past decade, the Ministry's focus has evolved from port modernisation under the Sagarmala Programme to a comprehensive blue economy strategy encompassing green shipping, inland waterways, shipbuilding, cruise tourism, and maritime infrastructure financing. Supported by initiatives such as the Maritime Amrit Kaal Vision 2047, the Union Budget 2026–27, the Indian Ports Act 2025, and the Sagarmala Finance Corporation Limited, the Ministry has entered a phase of accelerated implementation and investment.

This knowledge paper presents the strategic, institutional, and economic rationale for a structured partnership between the Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways and the Chamber of Commerce and Industry of India (CCI India). Rather than offering a descriptive overview, it provides an evidence-based analysis aligned with current policies, programmes, and sector priorities to support informed decision-making.

CCI India seeks to contribute as an implementation partner by leveraging its nationwide industry network, policy research expertise, investment facilitation capabilities, and stakeholder outreach. Through a formal collaboration framework, CCI India aims to support the Ministry in accelerating infrastructure development, promoting innovation, attracting investment, and strengthening India's maritime ecosystem.

Prepared for the consideration of the Hon'ble Union Minister, Minister of State, senior officials of the Ministry, NITI Aayog, DPIIT, industry leaders, investors, and development institutions, this paper is offered as a practical roadmap for advancing India's maritime transformation through collaborative action.

**Chamber of Commerce and Industry (CCI India)**



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# About CCI India

CCI India (The Chamber of Commerce and Industry of India) is a premier national business chamber dedicated to fostering economic growth, industry development, entrepreneurship, innovation, and investment promotion across India. As the voice of Indian business and industry, CCI India serves as a bridge between government, industry, startups, academia, investors, and civil society, facilitating meaningful collaboration for nation-building and sustainable development.

Through policy advocacy, business facilitation, research, stakeholder engagement, capacity building, and strategic partnerships, CCI India works to create an enabling environment for enterprises of all sizes. The Chamber actively supports key national initiatives such as Startup India, Make in India, Digital India, Atmanirbhar Bharat, Skill India, and Viksit Bharat 2047 by connecting innovative enterprises with government opportunities and promoting inclusive economic development.

CCI India operates through sector-specific councils, industry forums, knowledge platforms, and state-level engagements that address emerging opportunities and challenges across sectors including manufacturing, agriculture, technology, healthcare, education, infrastructure, sustainability, MSMEs, and startups. The Chamber regularly organizes policy dialogues, investment summits, business delegations, workshops, conferences, and knowledge-sharing initiatives to strengthen India's economic ecosystem.

With a strong commitment to innovation, entrepreneurship, and public-private collaboration, CCI India strives to empower enterprises, facilitate investment, enhance competitiveness, and contribute to India's journey toward becoming a globally competitive and economically resilient nation. Its role as a knowledge partner and industry catalyst enables ministries, departments, state governments, startups, and businesses to collaborate effectively in achieving national development objectives.



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# 1. Introduction to the Ministry

## 1.1 Constitutional and Legislative Mandate

Ports, shipping and inland water transport occupy a distinctive position within India's federal structure. Major ports fall under the Union List of the Seventh Schedule of the Constitution, while minor and intermediate ports fall under the Concurrent List, creating a layered governance architecture in which the Ministry exercises direct administrative control over the twelve Major Port Authorities while engaging State Maritime Boards on a coordinating basis for non-major ports. Shipping and navigation on tidal waters, together with maritime shipping and admiralty jurisdiction, are Union subjects, giving the Ministry primary legislative competence over vessel registration, seafarer certification, and merchant shipping regulation. This bifurcated structure has long created coordination friction between Union and State authorities, a friction that the Ministry's more recent unification efforts, including the Sagarmala National Perspective Plan and the Indian Ports Act 2025, are explicitly designed to resolve through cooperative federalism mechanisms rather than centralisation.

## 1.2 Institutional Evolution

The Ministry's present form is the product of repeated institutional restructuring that reflects the evolving strategic weight assigned to the maritime sector. The erstwhile Ministry of Surface Transport was divided in 1999 into separate shipping and road transport functions, recombined in 2004, and separated again in 2009 into a standalone Ministry of Shipping. The most consequential transformation occurred in November 2020, when the Ministry of Shipping was renamed and substantively expanded into the Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways, an act the Prime Minister characterised as bringing greater clarity of mandate. This was not a cosmetic rebranding: it formally consolidated port governance, inland waterways and the blue economy agenda under a single ministerial authority for the first time, removing a longstanding institutional ambiguity in which ports, shipping and inland navigation had been governed through overlapping and occasionally competing administrative silos.



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